

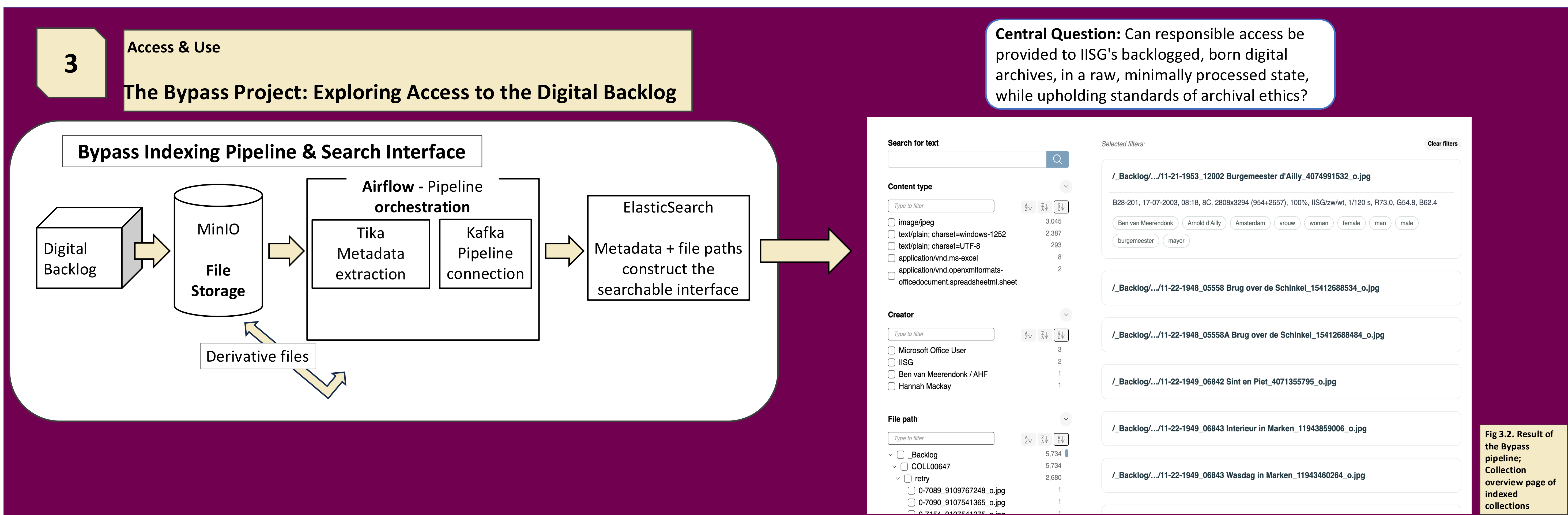
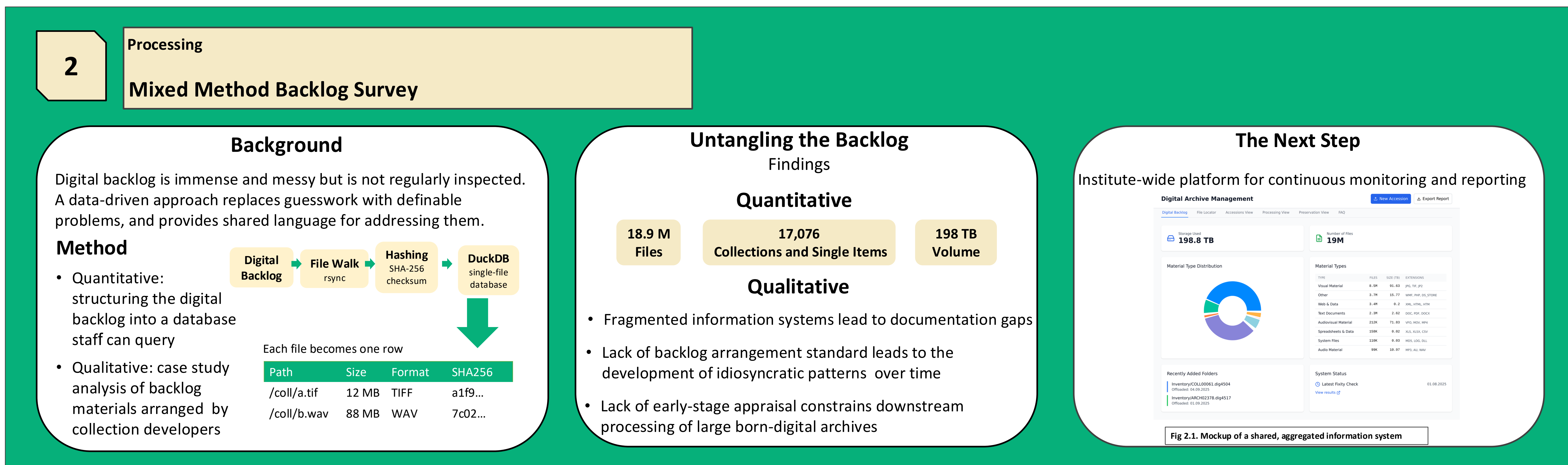
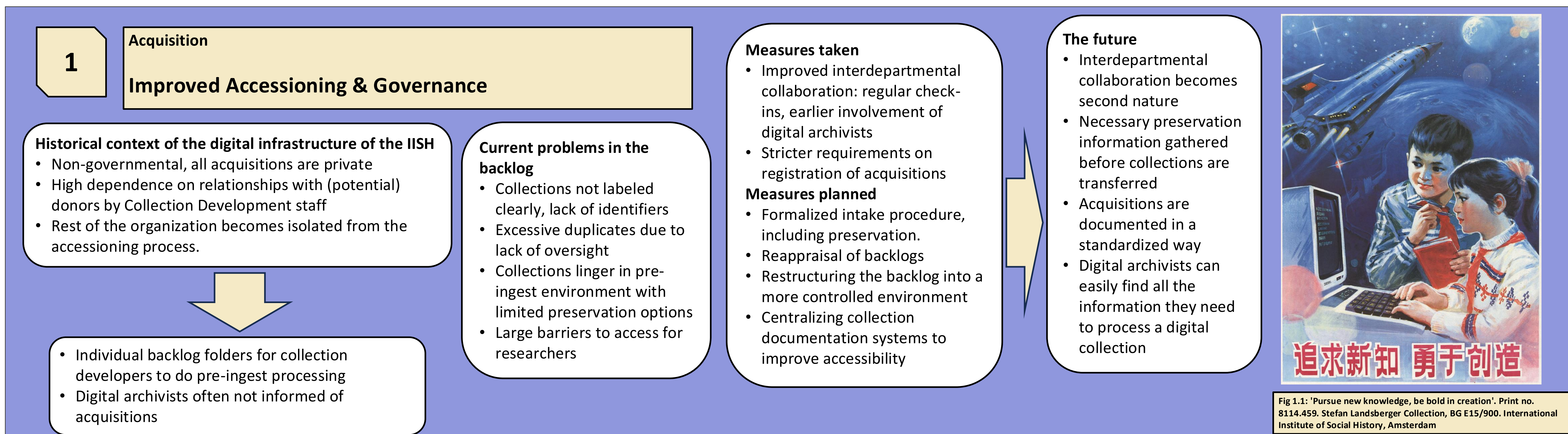
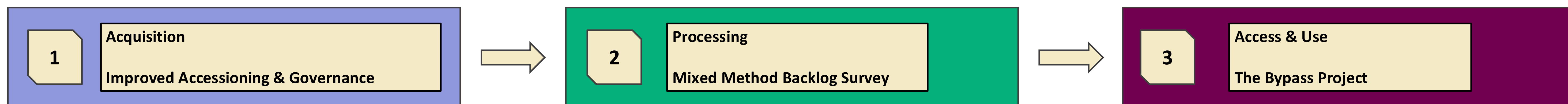
Exploring a Holistic Approach for Confronting a Legacy Backlog

Born-digital preservation across the archival lifecycle at a non-governmental archive

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One backlog, three points of intervention

The International Institute of Social History (IISH) has collected archives on social movements and labor history since 1935. Decades of prioritizing acquisition over standardization have left the Institute with an unwieldy born-digital backlog. This poster presents three interconnected efforts to address it: reforming accessioning practices, surveying the backlog through mixed-method analysis, and piloting access to unprocessed collections through the Bypass project. The overarching collaboration across departments at different stages of the lifecycle is as much the experiment as any single result.



A holistic approach: the whole is greater than the parts

Reforming accessioning practices, surveying the backlog, and piloting access through Bypass together demonstrate that meaningful progress in digital preservation practice requires a holistic, multidisciplinary approach that addresses every stage of the preservation lifecycle, from intake to long-term access. No single intervention is sufficient in isolation; rather, organizational reform, data-driven analysis, and technical experimentation must be pursued concurrently and in dialogue with one another.